

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

What is the Witness Protection Program?



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe rules and obligations through a wider range of language and expressions in both work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read the newspaper?
- Are there any big criminal trials happening in your country right now? What are they about?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about rules, regulations, crime and punishment.
- I can talk about things I have done or have been doing.
- I can talk about what is supposed to happen.





Let's Explore!

Let's read about the Witness Protection Program. What do critics **claim***?

* You can use the word "*claim*" when you talk about what people believe.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

What is the Witness Protection Program? It is a program that protects witnesses who are willing to testify against criminals. It has been protecting people since the 1960s. It now includes up to a thousand witnesses every year, at a cost of millions of US dollars. Some of the protected witnesses are innocent citizens who unintentionally witness a violent crime. They may be threatened by those criminals they can testify against. Generally, these individuals should be protected by the police until the trial. Afterwards, they are supposed to be relocated to another part of the country, or in some cases even to another country. The Justice Department is supposed to arrange new identities, new homes and new jobs for them.

Often witnesses are convicted criminals who are willing to testify against other criminals. For example, some of them are allowed to keep part of the money they gained illegally. They are supposed to be kept safe until the trial. Many witnesses have been hiding in a protected prison cell or in a secret hiding place such as a mountain hideaway or a hotel room. After their release they should be sent to other cities with new identities. From the beginning, there has been much public criticism of the Witness Protection Program. Critics claim that "making deals" with murderers and other violent criminals is bad.





Let's Practice!

What do you know about the Witness Protection Program?

Instructions: Read the sentences and select all the modals. Check the pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Innocent witnesses may be threatened by convicted criminals they can testify against.
2. Generally, these individuals should be protected by the police until the trial.
3. Afterwards, they might be relocated to another part of the country, or in some cases even to another country.
4. They must be kept safe in a hideaway until the trial.
5. After their release they should be sent to other cities with new identities.



Let's Practice!

What can witnesses expect in the Witness Protection Program?

Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence.

1. is / for / . / jobs / supposed / Department / them / identities / new / arrange / Justice / and / new / The / new / homes / to

2. They / to / be / safe / until / trial / kept / the / supposed / are / .

3. protect / these / individuals / . / supposed / are / police / The / to

4. People / law / the / are / . / obey / supposed / to



Extension Activity

Describe your life in Witness Protection.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine that you had to go into the Witness Protection Plan.
- If you could choose a new life, what would it be like? Where would you want to live? What would you want to do? Who would you bring with you?
- Write a letter to the Justice Department and make some requests for your new life.
- Exchange letters with a partner and decide if the requests your partner made are reasonable.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about rules, regulations, crime and punishment.

☐ ☐

I talk about things I have done and have been doing.

☐ ☐

I talk about what is supposed to happen.

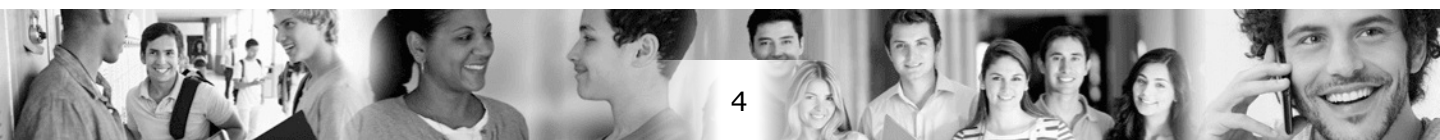
☐ ☐

I write a letter about being in the Witness Protection Program.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to testify** (verb): to make a statement based on personal knowledge or belief against a suspected criminal
e.g. It is a program that protects witnesses who are willing to testify against criminals.
- up to** (adverb): a maximum of
e.g. It now includes up to a thousand witnesses every year.
- innocent** (adjective): not guilty; blameless
e.g. Some of the protected witnesses are innocent citizens who unintentionally witness a violent crime.
- to arrange** (verb): to organize
e.g. The Justice Department is supposed to arrange new identities, new homes and new jobs for them.
- convicted** (adjective): found guilty of a crime
e.g. Often witnesses are convicted criminals who are willing to testify against other criminals.
- to gain** (verb): to earn
e.g. For example, some of them are allowed to keep part of the money they gained illegally.
- hideaway** (noun): a secret place to stay
e.g. Many witnesses have been hiding in a protected prison cell or in a secret hiding place such as a mountain hideaway or a hotel room.
- identity** (noun): who a person is
e.g. After their release they should be sent to other cities with new identities.
- critic** (noun): a person who expresses a negative opinion of something
e.g. Critics claim that "making deals" with murderers and other violent criminals is bad.





Learning Points

Modal Verbs in the Passive Voice

You use modal verbs to add meaning to other verbs. They come before the dictionary form (Infinitive without 'to') of the main verb.

Modal verbs (*can, must, have to, may, might*) can add meaning connected with certainty or obligation.

You can use modal verbs in the passive voice.

You use the passive voice when you want to focus on the receiver of the action, rather than the 'doer' of the action.

Here is the structure of a passive sentence:

Subject + To be + past participle

For example:

*They **are threatened** by those criminals they can testify against.*

You can add a modal verb before the To be.

Subject + modal + To be + past participle

For example:

*They **may be threatened** by those criminals they can testify against.*

Here the sentence now has an additional meaning of possibility, thanks to the modal **may**.

Examples:

- *They may be threatened by those criminals they can testify against.*
- *Generally, these individuals should be protected by the police until the trial.*
- *After their release they should be sent to other cities with new identities.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Continuous Tense vs. Present Perfect Tense

You use the Present Perfect Continuous tense to talk about an action that began in the past and is still continuing to the present time.

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action that has a connection to the present time. The action either finished in the past, just recently finished or, in some cases, continues to the present time.

The main difference between these two tenses is that you use the Present Perfect Continuous when you want to emphasize that the action began in the past and **is still continuing now**.

Some verbs are NOT used in the continuous form. Some common examples are: *to be*, *to have* and *to know*.

You often use the Present Perfect Continuous with words that talk about a period of time continuing up to the present, like *recently*, *this week*, *since March*, *for the last two days*.

Examples:

- *From the beginning, there has been much public criticism of the Witness Protection Program.*
- *It has been protecting people since the 1960s.*
- *Many witnesses have been hiding in a protected prison cell or in a secret hiding place such as a mountain hideaway or a hotel room.*

